Question ID 568d66a7

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Right triangles and trigonometry	

ID: 568d66a7

An isosceles right triangle has a perimeter of $94 + 94\sqrt{2}$ inches. What is the length, in inches, of one leg of this triangle?

A. 47

B. $47\sqrt{2}$

C. 94

D. $94\sqrt{2}$

ID: 568d66a7 Answer

Correct Answer:
B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. It's given that the right triangle is isosceles. In an isosceles right triangle, the two legs have equal lengths, and the length of the hypotenuse is $\sqrt{2}$ times the length of one of the legs. Let ℓ represent the length, in inches, of each leg of the isosceles right triangle. It follows that the length of the hypotenuse is $\ell\sqrt{2}$ inches. The perimeter of a figure is the sum of the lengths of the sides of the figure. Therefore, the perimeter of the isosceles right triangle is $\ell + \ell + \ell\sqrt{2}$ inches. It's given that the perimeter of the triangle is $94 + 94\sqrt{2}$ inches. It follows that $\ell + \ell + \ell\sqrt{2} = 94 + 94\sqrt{2}$. Factoring the left-hand side of this equation yields $\left(1 + 1 + \sqrt{2}\right)\ell = 94 + 94\sqrt{2}$, or $\left(2 + \sqrt{2}\right)\ell = 94 + 94\sqrt{2}$. Dividing both sides of this equation by $2 + \sqrt{2}$ yields $\ell = \frac{94+94\sqrt{2}}{2+\sqrt{2}}$. Rationalizing the denominator of the right-hand side of this equation by multiplying the right-hand side of the equation by $\frac{2-\sqrt{2}}{2-\sqrt{2}}$ yields $\ell = \frac{\left(94+94\sqrt{2}\right)\left(2-\sqrt{2}\right)}{\left(2+\sqrt{2}\right)\left(2-\sqrt{2}\right)}$. Applying the distributive property to the numerator and to the denominator of the right-hand side of this equation yields $\ell = \frac{188-94\sqrt{2}+188\sqrt{2}-94\sqrt{4}}{4-2\sqrt{2}+2\sqrt{2}-\sqrt{4}}$. This is equivalent to $\ell = \frac{94\sqrt{2}}{2}$, or $\ell = 47\sqrt{2}$. Therefore, the length, in inches, of one leg of the isosceles right triangle is $47\sqrt{2}$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect. This is the length, in inches, of the hypotenuse.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Question Difficulty:
Hard